Connecting Ollama to n8n

Setup guide for running gpt-oss:20b locally and using it in n8n

Quick note: the base URL belongs to the Ollama server, not to a specific model. Every model on that machine shares the same URL, and you pick the model (gpt-oss:20b) separately in the n8n node.

1. Install and pull the model

```
ollama pull gpt-oss:20b
ollama pull qwen3:30b
```

2. Base URL (default)

```
http://localhost:11434
```

3. Check that it works and the model is there

```
curl http://localhost:11434/api/tags
```

This lists your installed models. You should see `gpt-oss:20b` in the output. You can also run `ollama list`.

4. Which URL to put in n8n depends on where n8n runs

n8n runs...	Base URL
On the same machine (npm / desktop)	`http://localhost:11434`
In Docker, Ollama on the host	`http://host.docker.internal:11434`
On another machine / cloud	`http://<ollama-machine-ip>:11434`

For the Docker case on Linux, start n8n with `--add-host=host.docker.internal:host-gateway`.

5. If n8n is on a different machine, expose Ollama

By default Ollama only listens on localhost. To allow other machines:

```
# Linux/macOS
OLLAMA_HOST=0.0.0.0 ollama serve
```

On Windows, set `OLLAMA_HOST` to `0.0.0.0` as an environment variable and restart Ollama. Then get the machine's IP with `hostname -I` (Linux), `ipconfig getifaddr en0` (macOS) or `ipconfig` (Windows).

6. In n8n

Create an Ollama credential and paste the base URL. In the Ollama Chat Model node, choose `gpt-oss:20b` from the model dropdown. If the dropdown loads, the connection works.

For someone else installing this

The steps are the same on their own machine. Their base URL is just `http://localhost:11434`, or their machine's IP if n8n is elsewhere.

> **Security warning:** Don't expose port 11434 to the public internet without a firewall or authentication, since Ollama has no built-in auth.